Collated NZRA Responses to WRC Draft Criteria

The opinions collated here came from ten individuals in the NZRA. There was also indirect input from Neil Phillips, Lauri Lepik and various rogaining web sites within NZ and around the world.

Upper Limit

Nearly everyone agreed with an upper limit of 500-600. This was mainly to guarantee the adventure feel of a rogaine but also to make event organization more manageable with regard to landowner negotiations and infrastructure support.

- One person advocated no limit to entries; that the field size be the decision of the hosting country (based on what numbers the local context can host) to be part of their application to hold the event.

Team Size

Everyone agreed that limiting team size to 2 or 3 people made sense as these are the more competitive teams.

Competitiveness

Everyone was in agreement that every effort must be made to include the elite rogainers but there was plenty of discussion about how to do this:

- Most wanted to include national champions in all categories, esp. from host country,
- Too heavily weighted to past WRC winners,
- NZ Champs should be included with ERC, NARC and ARC as winners who get automatic entry as we have a formidable world-wide reputation in adventure sports,
- One person advocated no preference for former champions on the basis that this is how the World Orienteering Masters works,
- A few were against having regional champs as criteria for entry as it would exclude poor competitors (students?) and those from poorer countries from eligibility,
- It is not clear whether an eligible team has to be the complete team from the previous event or can be split into 2 or 3 teams and still be guaranteed entry,
- Assuming split teams still eligible, calculate over 800 possible competitors will fit elite entry criteria. If 25% take it up in WRC that means 200 elite competitors.

Diversity/Participation

General agreement that an WRC should include people from as many countries as possible, but

- Therefore shouldn't have to travel to regional events to qualify,
- One person expressed concern that including new/under represented countries might let uncompetitive teams push out elite teams,
- Others want to accommodate a mixture of elite and novices,
- Emphasis should be on international participation as well as elite competition, this is because at the current evolution of the sport international exchange of experience over as broad a spectrum as possible is the most important object.

Volunteerism

- One person disliked the idea of reserving places for volunteers on the premise that they should get their entry in early,

- Others say that as many leaders in the sport as possible should get to the WRC as this will help the sport grow,
- Several people think that the clause about people who have competed in the previous 4 events being guaranteed a future spot is silly, especially if this number increases each year, because it eliminates any future rogainers from qualifying.
- Diversity classification should be 30 people from each country that has an IRF representative at the event (estimate 12 countries).

Host Country

- Common desire to give host country some sort of preference to compete, (may be the only opportunity many get to attend a WRC)
- It might remove the incentive to hold a WRC if locals could miss out, too elitist,
- However pressure on entries in last two WRCs came from large local entries,
- Rogaining would benefit if WRC attracts lots of new locals to the sport,
- Suggest 100 places from host country reserved. Following this and the calculations of numbers in the previous sections:
- **Summary of all special categories and estimated numbers who would come to a WRC (assuming split teams qualify):**
    - **Elite** **888 – 25% subscribed** **= 222**
    - **Special categories, host country** **460 – 50% subscribed** **= 230**
    - **Open registration** **remaining out of 500** **= 50**

Entry Cut-off Timing

- General feeling that a two-tier entry ~~timing~~ with two time-steps would work, (Emma, below you say timing should be in parallel)
- Suggest allocate half the places to the elite and special categories, and half on a first-come-first served basis,
- First-come first-served benefits event organisers,
- This suggested proposal:
    - There are two entry lists of equal size. Both open at the same time and stay open until filled or a time period of perhaps three months has elapsed.
    - One list is for inter-continental rogainers (those who would have to travel over 1000 kms and must travel over water from their home country) and the other for everyone else; local and adjacent land-joined countries.
    - After three months, any un-subscribed vacancies in either list would be filled from over-subscription in the other list, and entries could be held open if vacancies still existed.
    - The allocation and rationing of the "local" people should be left to the discretion of the organising country. They may reserve elite places if they wish, or have a special pre-booking slot for elites, but out of their local allocation.

General

- Selection criteria is based on teams, but teams reform – only 1 member of team may meet criteria.
- The biggest concern of many was that the process for finalising the criteria be as widely spread as possible,
- It was felt that there was no need to rush it and that the process undertaken to select the criteria was even more important that the final criteria, (i.e., getting input and agreement rather than the result per se)
- Concern that the IRF is doing the selecting and there should be room for input from local organisers, e.g. one person suggested financial viability of the event requires

that elitist categories need to be carefully considered by the organisers and not necessarily adopted.

- A sense that NZ may choose not to accept the criteria, particularly since they may be implemented at short notice, not long before opening date of entries – catching entrants off-guard. What then?

Emma de Lacey May 2009